

Where we are, and the two things we decide Saturday

Short version: it is no longer a file I email you. It is a live site, the benefit research is real and cited, and it is ready for veterans to touch. Saturday is about the name and the money.

1 It is live

Since we last talked it moved from an attachment to a real site that updates within a minute of any change. Open it on your phone.

<https://kalebaverell.github.io>

Temporary address. It changes the day we settle the name, which is decision 1 below.

- **Real state benefit data for all 51 jurisdictions** (50 states plus DC), each program cited to its official source, last verified July 8, 2026
- **Funded path** - not just what to do, but how to pay for it
- **Free account** so a veteran's plan is still there next week, on any device
- **Works on phones**, installs like an app, and works offline once opened
- **Reserves & National Guard tab** - 10 federal benefits plus state tuition programs, the "best kept secret" you flagged
- **Pathfinder** - 10 questions in, a recommended direction and a 30/60/90 plan out
- **Privacy policy and terms** written to match what the site actually does
- **Printable gameplan** a veteran can walk out of your meeting holding

Honest line on the data: state benefits, federal benefits, and the Reserve/Guard content are real and cited. The career library and the sample veteran are still demo content, clearly labeled as such in the app.

2 Before Saturday: ten minutes, on your phone

1. Open the address above and **create a free account** with your email. Takes about a minute.
2. Run **Pathfinder** and answer the 10 questions *as yourself*, not as a tester.
3. Look at the plan it gives you. **Does anything in it read as wrong to a veteran?** That is the only question I need answered.
4. Tap into **Reserves & Guard**. You said this is the best kept secret in the community. Tell me if it lands that way.

If anything makes you hesitate to hand it to someone you know, write that down. That reaction is worth more than a feature request.

3 Decision one: the name

We are on a temporary address and every deliverable says VetPath. The longer that stays true, the more expensive changing it gets.

Question	Where it stands
Keep VetPath?	It is descriptive, it is short, and everything is already built around it.
Is it available?	Not checked yet. Domain and trademark both need a real search before we commit. I did not want to spend the research budget on a name we might drop Saturday.
Real domain	Needed either way. The GitHub address is fine for testing and wrong for veterans.
If we change it	Cheapest now. It touches the site, the printed pieces, and the account system.

Bring two or three alternatives you would be comfortable saying out loud at your meeting. We pick one Saturday and I register it the same day.

4 Decision two: how it pays for itself

The rule I would hold to: **free for veterans, always.** The question is who does pay.

Route	What it means, and the honest catch
Organizations pay	VSOs, universities, and employers license it for the veterans they serve. Closest to the mission, slowest to close.
Grants and sponsors	Veteran-focused foundations and corporate giving. Real money, but it needs a nonprofit arm or a fiscal sponsor to receive most of it.
Entity structure	This is the fork underneath the other two. Nonprofit opens grants and closes investment. For-profit is the reverse. We should decide the direction Saturday even if we file later.
Referral fees	Parked, deliberately. See the flag below before we reopen it.

Why referrals are parked. The idea of earning a fee for sending veterans to a lender or a realtor is the one revenue route that could cost us the whole thing. Paid referrals in mortgage and real estate are governed by federal law, and steering a veteran toward someone who pays us is exactly the behavior a veteran should distrust. It also reads badly that the natural first referrals are family. I am not a lawyer and this is not legal advice, so if we want this route it needs a real attorney's read first, not a decision at a kitchen table. My recommendation is that we stay a planning tool that points to free accredited help and never takes a cut.

5 What is still open, and who owns it

FRANK Ten minutes on the site before Saturday, plus two or three name candidates.

FRANK **Pick a pilot date** at your recurring meeting. This is the one thing I cannot do without you.

FRANK Five to ten veterans willing to use it in front of us and say what they actually think.

KALEB **Sign in with Google and Microsoft** is built and waiting. The buttons appear on their own once I finish the vendor setup. Email sign-in works today.

KALEB A real sending address for password resets, and a privacy contact address on the legal pages.

KALEB Register the domain the day we pick the name.

KALEB Partner one-pager: what a VSO, university, or employer actually gets, and what it costs them.

Still the thing that matters most: watching real veterans use this at your meeting. The name and the money get easier after we have seen ten people touch it. If Saturday only produces a pilot date, it was a good Saturday.

VetPath is a planning and education tool. It is not the VA, a law firm, or an accredited claims representative, and nothing here is legal, medical, or financial advice. State, federal, and Reserve/Guard benefit content is researched from official sources and dated in the app; the career library and sample veteran are demo content. Eligibility and dollar amounts change and must be confirmed through VA.gov, your state veterans agency, or an accredited VSO. Fit scores are decision support, not guarantees.